

NOVUS HACKATHON · OCTOBER 2026

# Ghost Requests

v1 · Staff board for Cortex Chat

What users asked Novus chat that it **couldn't deliver**, sorted by **why**.

Built on Novus · Cortex Chat · Claude Haiku · pg-boss · Tenant schemas

## THE PROBLEM

# When chat can't help, the ask just disappears.

“

She's left wondering whether she's asking incorrectly or Novus can't do it.

Customer call recap · Sep 16

21

**agent issue instances in 30 days**

Novus Chat agent, NOVUS-1949

3

**manual chat audits in 6 weeks**

One-off, by hand, too late

0

**views of why an ask failed**

Every failure looks the same

## HOW IT WORKS

# A background pass over every tenant's chat.

### Collect

Each tenant's recent chat turns, with the tools chat called and whether they failed.

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### Flag

Keep only turns with a failure signal. The rest are never sent to the model.

›

### Classify

Claude Haiku judges each turn against what Novus can really do.

›

### Store

Verdicts saved in the tenant's own schema, quotes redacted.

›

### Board

Staff see clusters merged across all tenants.

## Five failure signals

### Tool error

a tool chat called failed

### Empty reply

chat said nothing

### Refusal

"can't", "not supported"

### Unbacked write

claimed a change, no tool succeeded

### Correction

user said "that's wrong"

# Six reasons an ask fails. Six different fixes.

|                                                                                                 |                                                                                               |                                                                     |                                                                                  |                                                                                        |                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unfindable</b><br><br>Novus does it; the user couldn't find it.<br><br><b>Fix navigation</b> | <b>Partial</b><br><br>It exists, but stops short of the ask.<br><br><b>Extend the feature</b> | <b>Unmet</b><br><br>Novus can't do it.<br><br><b>Roadmap demand</b> | <b>Data gap</b><br><br>The data was never collected.<br><br><b>Instrument it</b> | <b>Chat miss</b><br><br>A tool existed; chat got it wrong.<br><br><b>Fix the agent</b> | <b>Met</b><br><br>Flagged, but chat delivered.<br><br><b>False alarm</b> |
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*Judged against Novus's real settings and admin capabilities, so every verdict names the evidence that decided it.*

# What chat missed, and for how many accounts.



# Safe with tenant data. And it pointed to v2.

## ✓ Staff-only

Admin guard on every route; the board reads across tenants.

## ✓ Tenant-isolated

One job per tenant, verdicts in that tenant's schema.

## ✓ Redacted

Emails, phone numbers and tokens stripped from quotes.

## ✓ Injection-safe

Chat text travels as JSON data, never as instructions.

## ✓ Re-runnable

Versioned classifier; already-judged turns are skipped.

## ✓ Resilient

A failed batch costs only itself; moving tenants are reported.

## WHAT v1 TAUGHT US

**Detection works.** But a staff board only helps us, and only for our own chat.

Customers run their own agents and have the same blind spot. **v2 gives it to them, and makes every ask actionable.**



v1 tells us **why** Novus chat failed — so the right team fixes the right thing.

**Ghost Requests v1**

Thank you · Questions?